

Get on the technology world map

Digit was recently at Computex Taipei 2010, to get a first-hand look at emerging technology trends from around the world. You can read Digit's coverage in our buzz section (pg. 8), and will also find more pictures and videos from the event online at www.thinkdigit.com.

I've always looked forward to Computex, because apart from being the second-largest technology exhibition in the world, it's also Asia's biggest, with a lot of products that are more relevant to us Indians, rather than just US-centric gadgets that are of no practical use in India.

What's always irked me, however, is that we have to travel abroad for such exhibitions. As Digit representatives, it's a lot easier for one of us to travel to Computex, CeBIT, CES, etc., but where does that leave you? Although you'll see a lot of coverage from magazines like Digit, or online at sites like thinkdigit.com, nothing beats "being there", does it?

Most of the exhibitions we see around us are more to do with mainstream consumer durables, as that's what seems to get attendance. But none of them are even close to the size of CeBIT or Computex. This is just sad, in a country which is considered to be a hot-bed for developers, entrepreneurs and geeks in general, and is touted as one of the world's fastest growing economies and consumer markets.

When talking to people in the industry, the general perception is that housing, job and home expos get attendance, the rest just don't. With more tech companies than ever looking to target India's gigantic market (you), and seeing a lot of potential in our country, I personally think it's time for us to get on the technology world-map.

Perhaps a gross over-simplification, but I think there are three basic things needed to pull off something like a Computex in India – support from the government, an interest from exhibitors and a desire and passion on your behalf to attend.

Look at what the expos have done for the countries or cities they're held in. With hordes of tourists bringing in foreign currency once a

year, and the city being put on the global map, there's obvious value for the government.

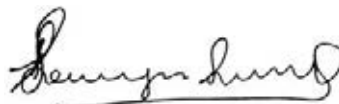
Large companies (potential exhibitors), have shown an increasing interest in India, and you've surely seen the change all around you, over the past five years or so. New brands, new gadgets, way too many ads, and an embarrassment of choices.

That just leaves you. I'd like all of you to write in to us and tell us what you'd like to see and experience at the theoretical expo I'm talking about. Would you travel within India to experience it? Does this even interest you at all?

I ask you to write in because I'm trying to understand whether Digit can play a part in exposing all of you to some cutting-edge technology, and also expose the world to some cutting-edge Indian ideas. However, regardless of whether we succeed in putting India on the world expo map, I certainly think Digit can play its part in showcasing the work a lot of you do in the technology field.

We're approaching our 63rd birthday as a free country next month, and Digit is planning on showcasing India, Indians, and made in India technologies. Obviously, we need our community to help us identify noteworthy Indians in technology who may not have got the limelight they deserve. Make sure to get in touch with us, and let us know. We're also going to have a few polls online at thinkdigit.com, so make sure to look for those to express your opinions.

Finally, those of you who did not look at the back page of the DIY Fast Track last month, please do so immediately. Although I'm happy to report that most of the Rs. 4 crore in free gifts we promised have been claimed, I'd be happier still if all of you responded and claimed everything we're offering. We've extended the deadline to the end of July, so as to allow stragglers to catch up and get their free goodies. 


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